

WEIGHT WATCH

India is now one of the top weight-obsessed nations in the world—with 48 per cent perennially trying to lose weight, 79 per cent on an exercise binge and 69 per cent eternally half-starved, says a new AC Nielsen online survey. The fixation has a new name: Weight neurosis. It's called neurosis because deprivation can make you grumpy, boring and miserable. That sounds serious, and it is, but the silver lining is that people afflicted with this condition can get by with help, say medics.



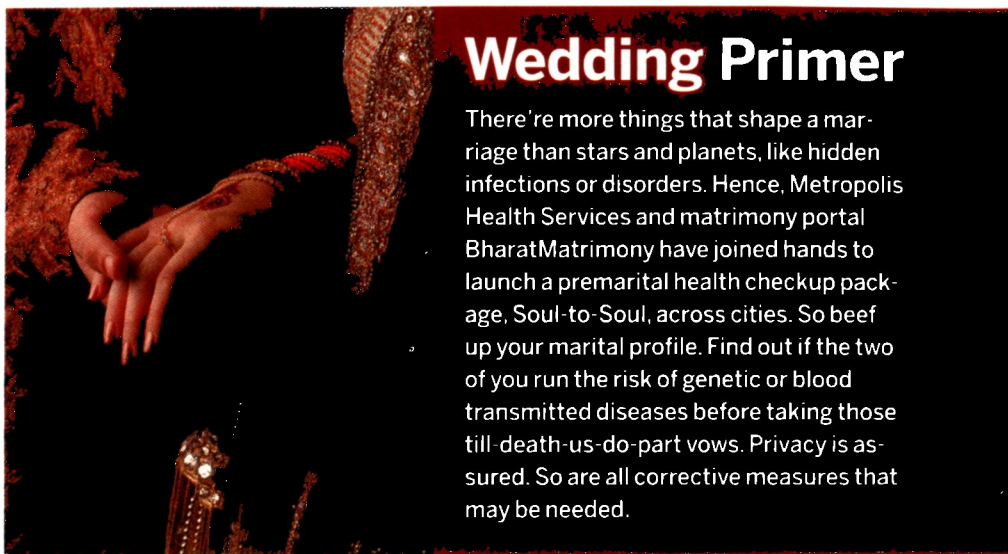
BANDEEP SINGH

54%

OF URBAN INDIANS ARE UNHAPPY WITH THEIR BODY SIZE AND SHAPE

CLICK for risk

Bangalore's Manipal Hospital has just launched an innovative online health information tool—the 'Manipal Symptom Checker'. If you've been feeling uneasy about some symptoms, log on to www.manipalhospital.com and key in your problems. It's simple and can be assessed anywhere and anytime.



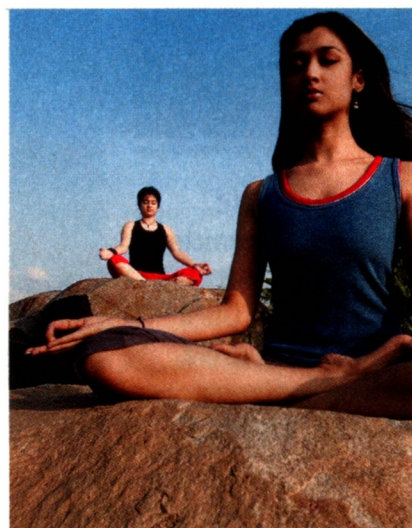
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Wedding Primer

There're more things that shape a marriage than stars and planets, like hidden infections or disorders. Hence, Metropolis Health Services and matrimony portal BharatMatrimony have joined hands to launch a premarital health checkup package, Soul-to-Soul, across cities. So beef up your marital profile. Find out if the two of you run the risk of genetic or blood transmitted diseases before taking those till death-us-do-part vows. Privacy is assured. So are all corrective measures that may be needed.

How to Live to 100

We know we won't live forever. But as long as we are of sound mind and body, most of us would like to stick around for as long as we can. Spend an hour on livingto100.com to figure out your life expectancy. This online crystal-ball calculator predicts when your body would finally fail you. It turns out that every choice we make affects our projected expiration date. Cheat on your diet, and you subtract precious time. But more and more evidence shows that simple tasks like exercising may not only add years to your life but also delay the onset of disabilities in your golden years.

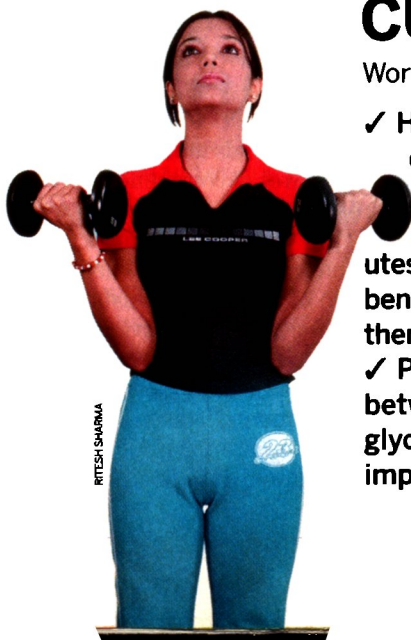


SUMEET INDER SINGH

CUTTING edge

Work out smarter with the latest gym tips

- ✓ Have a coffee before you work out. Or a diet coke. A caffeine buzz is ideal for pushing yourself just a little bit further.
- ✗ Don't work out endlessly. After 45 minutes of intense exercise, your body does not benefit any more and almost all you do from then on is unproductive.
- ✓ Progressively shortening periods of rest between sets of weight training raises the glycogen holding capacity of muscles, and improves your endurance.



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